



PRINT

DOC NO. RL-BRAND-001-PRINT-A REV. A RIPOSTE LABORATORIES

The brand was designed as printed matter, so it prints well – but screen RGB and press CMYK are different colour spaces and the accents are the ones that suffer.

CONTENTS

▶ 1 • The honest warning about CMYK	2
▶ 2 • Spot colour (recommended for anything that matters)	3
▶ 3 • Rule weights – the thing that breaks	4
▶ 4 • Type on paper	5
▶ 5 • Paper	6
▶ 6 • Layout	6
▶ 7 • Web-to-print (@media print)	7
▶ 8 • Handing off to a printer	7
▶ 9 • Checklist	8

SEC.01

1 • THE HONEST WARNING ABOUT CMYK

The CMYK values in `color-reference.md`^{RL-BRAND-001-COLOR-REFERENCE} and `palettes/riposte.csv` are **naive device conversions**, computed arithmetically from RGB. They are a starting point to hand a printer. They are **not** a colour specification.

Three of our colours sit outside or near the edge of the CMYK gamut:

COLOUR	PROBLEM ON PRESS
teal <code>#12B795</code>	Well outside CMYK gamut. Will print duller and darker than screen. The single biggest shift in the palette.
pink <code>#F0477D</code>	Near the gamut edge. Loses fluorescence; drifts toward a flatter rose.
orange <code>#FE9A0D</code>	Prints close, but can go muddy if the press pulls magenta.

Always ask for a physical proof before a run of any size. Approve the proof, not the numbers.

SEC.02 2 • SPOT COLOUR (RECOMMENDED FOR ANY-THING THAT MATTERS)

For business cards, stickers, packaging, labels and signage, specify **spot inks**. The accents are the brand; a dull teal is a broken brand.

Starting points to confirm against a physical Pantone book under D50 light – **do not approve from a screen**:

TOKEN	HEX	NEAREST PANTONE (COATED) – VERIFY PHYSICALLY
ink	#1D1A17	Black 6 C, or Neutral Black C
bone	#F6F1E7	Warm Gray 1 C at low tint, or an uncoated natural stock
pink	#F0477D	191 C / 1915 C
orange	#FE9A0D	1375 C / 137 C
teal	#12B795	3395 C / 339 C

Bone should usually be the paper, not an ink. A warm uncoated natural stock is closer to the brand than printing #F6F1E7 onto white – and cheaper. See §5.

SEC.03

3 • RULE WEIGHTS – THE THING THAT BREAKS

The system is drawn in 2px screen rules. At print scale, translate as:

SCREEN	PRINT	WHY
1px dashed divider	0.5pt	Below this it drops out
2px solid structural rule	1.5pt minimum, 2pt preferred	Do not go below 1pt. The entire visual structure is these rules; if they vanish, the design vanishes
6px accent top bar	3mm	
8px accent left bar	4mm	

Set all rules to **overprint off** and hold them at 100% of a single ink where possible – a 1.5pt rule built from four-colour black will show registration fringing.

SEC.04

4 • TYPE ON PAPER

ROLE	SIZE	NOTES
Body	9.5-10pt / 15pt leading	JetBrains Mono is wide; don't go below 9pt
md secondary	8.5-9pt	
Labels, chrome	7-7.5pt, .1em tracked	The tracking matters more in print, not less
h3	14-16pt	
h2	18-22pt	
h1 / page head	28-36pt	
Display	60pt+	

- ▶ **Embed the font.** JetBrains Mono is OFL – embedding and redistribution are permitted.
- ▶ Weight 400 for body, 700 for headings, 800 for display and stat figures.
- ▶ Ink text should be **100% K plus a touch of warmth** (e.g. C0 M10 Y21 K89 from the conversion table) – not registration black, which cracks on folds and shows through.
- ▶ Reversed type (bone on ink) needs a **1pt minimum stroke weight**; at 7pt, tracked uppercase, thin strokes fill in with ink spread. Bump to 8pt reversed.

SEC.05

5 • PAPER

The whole visual language is "printed on bone paper". Choose stock accordingly:

- ▶ **Uncoated, warm white or natural.** Not bright white, not coated gloss.
- ▶ Target something close to #F6F1E7 in the stock itself. Then **bone** costs no ink and looks right by definition.
- ▶ **Weights:** 120-170 gsm text, 300-350 gsm cards and covers.
- ▶ **Avoid gloss.** The brand has no shine – no blur, no glow, no gradients. A soft-touch or uncoated finish is on-message; gloss lamination is not.
- ▶ Recycled and post-consumer stock is on-message in the most literal possible way. Say so in the colophon when you use it.

SEC.06

6 • LAYOUT

Margins	15mm minimum, 18mm preferred
Bleed	3mm, with all bands and full-bleed fields extended into it
Spacing	-space-4 → 4mm • -space-6 → 8mm • -space-8 → 15mm
Radius	0. Do not let a template round a corner
Bands	Checker 26px → 7mm • Harlequin 38px → 10mm

Keep the **.pagehead** tri-band and the colophon footer. A printed Ri-poste document should be recognisable as the same object as the web page.

SEC.07

7 • WEB-TO-PRINT (@media print)

`brand/riposte-brand.css` ships a print block that:

- ▶ drops to true black on white (ink-on-bone at 15.39:1 is lovely on screen; on a home laser printer, bone becomes a grey wash)
- ▶ hides `.marquee`, `.checker` and `.harlequin` – decoration that wastes toner
- ▶ underlines links

If you're generating a PDF for actual press (not a desktop printer), **override that block** and keep the real colours and bands. It exists for "someone hit Ctrl-P", not for production.

SEC.08

8 • HANDING OFF TO A PRINTER

Send:

1. The artwork as **PDF/X-4**, fonts embedded, 3mm bleed, crop marks
2. `palettes/riposte.ase` – loads in Illustrator, InDesign, Affinity
3. `palettes/riposte.csv` – every value in every notation
4. This page

Ask for:

- ▶ A **physical proof** on the actual stock
- ▶ **Spot inks** for the three accents where budget allows
- ▶ Confirmation that **rules are holding at 1.5pt** and are not being auto-thinned

SEC.09

9 • CHECKLIST

- ☐ Physical proof requested and approved on the real stock
- ☐ Structural rules $\geq 1.5\text{pt}$
- ☐ Fonts embedded (OFL permits it)
- ☐ Radius 0 everywhere
- ☐ Bleed 3mm, bands extended into it
- ☐ Ink text is warm black, not registration black
- ☐ Reversed type $\geq 8\text{pt}$
- ☐ Colophon present
- ☐ Teal checked on the proof specifically – it's the one that shifts most

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